Katherine Nina Thompson, PhD

Postdoctoral Research Fellow in the Centre for Longitudinal Studies, University College London

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Education

PhD in Social, Genetic, and Developmental Psychiatry, *King's College London,* Viva: Nov 2023 2020-2023
Awarded the London Interdisciplinary Social Science Doctoral Training Partnership Studentship
Thesis: The link between social isolation and mental health from childhood to young adulthood: Assessing longitudinal trends, bidirectional associations, and genetic overlap, supervised by Louise Arseneault & Timothy Matthews

MSc Genes, Environment and Development in Psychology and Psychiatry, *King's College London* 2018-2019
Thesis: Age and sex-related variability in the presentation of anxiety and depression symptoms in the GLAD study, supervised by Thalia Eley & Gerome Breen

BSc Psychology, *Loughborough University* 2014-2018
Thesis: Exploring relationships between maternal depression and anxiety symptoms, child temperament and parenting principles in 8-to-12-month-old infants, supervised by Emma Haycraft

Research

Committed to open and reproducible science: Pre-registrations on Open Science Framework and code on GitHub.

Research Fellow – Centre for Longitudinal Studies (CLS), **University College London** 2026-Present
Gender inequalities in population mental health, mentored by Dario Moreno Agostino

- Mapping indicators of sexism within UK longitudinal cohorts
- Co-production with young people
- Using causal inference to estimate the impact of sexism on depression and anxiety in young people
- Member of the Loneliness Working Group and the Responsible Genetics Collective

Postdoctoral Research Fellow – Dept of Sociology, College of Liberal Arts, **Purdue University** 2024-2026
Interdisciplinary Genomics Research Centre (IGRC), mentored by Robbee Wedow and Erin Dunn

- Developed pipelines for a data hub to house longitudinal cohorts: Add Health, WLS, HRS, UKB, MIDUS, ELSA
- Led project using innovative mixed models to ask: To what extent do systems contribute to concurrent and longitudinal depression symptoms?
- Led project using causal inference to ask: Can social connection mitigate disparities in depression symptoms?

PhD in Social, Genetic, and Developmental Psychiatry – SGDP Centre, **King's College London** 2020-2023
Environmental Risk Longitudinal Twin Study (E-Risk), led by Prof Louise Arseneault

- Led three projects applying longitudinal methods to understand the link between social isolation and mental health problems across development
- Expertise in longitudinal structural equation modelling: growth mixture modelling, latent class growth analysis, factor analysis, multinomial regression, cross-lagged panel models, random intercept cross-lagged panel models, longitudinal mediation, univariate, heterogeneity, and multivariate twin models, and independent pathway models

Research Assistant – NIHR Bioresource Centre Maudsley, **King's College London** 2019-2020
Genetic Links to Anxiety and Depression (GLAD) Study, Eating Disorders Genetics Initiative (EDGI) & Covid-19 Psychiatry and Neurological Genetics (COPING) Study, led by Gerome Breen

- Managed NHS participant recruitment and trained ~200 NHS Trusts and services on recruitment strategies
- Developed large-scale data management pipelines (N>20,000) and processing across multiple studies

Research Assistant – *Institute of Psychiatry, Psychology & Neuroscience*, **King's College London** 2016-2018
Early Development in Tuberous Sclerosis Study, led by Charlotte Tye

- Conducted a battery of behavioural assessments in infants across the UK and in the Birkbeck Baby Lab: Eye tracking, Mullen Scales of Early Learning, Autism Diagnostic Observation Schedule (ADOS) and EEG

Teaching and Mentoring

Teaching

Teaching materials for the Humane Genetics Curriculum (HGC): https://docs.lib.purdue.edu/hgc/21/
Guest Lecturer, Max Planck Institute for Human Development, 2026: Humboldt Universitaet Mind & Brain MSc
Senior Personnel and Instructor, Purdue University, 2026: Summer Institute for Longitudinal Data Analysis.
Guest Lecturer, Methodology Centre at Purdue University (MCAP), 2025: R Workshop
Senior Personnel and Instructor, Purdue University, 2025: Summer Institute for Longitudinal Data Analysis. Rated 4.81: 81% excellent and 19% very good.
Guest lecturer, Purdue University, 2024: Lecture for undergraduate sociogenomics class (SOC 391S)
Graduate Teaching Assistant, King's College London, 2021-2023: Introduction to Applied Statistics MSc module
Instructor, University of Greenwich 2026: Introduction to R for the Loneliness Working Group
Instructor, King's College London, 2020: R Workshop by the Translational Neuropsychiatric Genomics Lab
SLV Mental Health Placement in Sri Lanka, 2018: Clinical work at the National Institute of Mental Health

Maths Teacher, Cobden Primary School, Loughborough, 2017: After-school support

Mentoring
Mentor for Samuel Nemeth, Purdue University, 2025: PhD student in the Department of Sociology
Mentor for Aahan Bajpai, Purdue University, 2025: Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship (SURF)
Statistical Supervisor for MSc Students, King's College London, 2021-2023: DEV-PP MSc programme
Member of the LISS-DTP Committee, 2022: Representative for LISS-DTP-funded PhD students 2022
PhD Student Representative, King's College London, 2021-2023: Representative for SGDP PhD students

Presentations *(since 2020)*

Invited talks
PROMENTA Genetics Network, University of Oslo, 2026: Can social connection, acceptance, and belonging reduce disparities in depression symptoms?
Social, Genetic, Developmental Psychiatry Centre Seminar, King's College London, 2025: Can social connection, acceptance, and belonging reduce disparities in depression symptoms?
Biology, Social Disparities, and Development, Max Planck Institute, 2025: Overlap between social isolation and mental health symptoms: Longitudinal independent pathway model in a nationally representative cohort
Personality, Genetics and Mental Health Research Seminar, PROMENTA Oslo, 2024: Drawing parallels across complex trait genomics and social science: A framework to combine social and genetic risk factors for depression
Research visit to Children's Psychosocial Maladjustment (GRIP) Lab, Université Laval, Quebec, 2024: Oral presentation: Drawing parallels across complex trait genomics and social science: A framework to combine social and genetic risk factors for depression
Avon and Wiltshire Mental Health Partnership Research & Development Conference 2020: Oral presentation: The impact of the GLAD Study in psychiatric research and clinical practice
Science Gallery London 2020: How to communicate genetic research on anxiety and depression

International conference presentations
European Psychiatric Association Section of Epidemiology & Social Psychiatry 2026: Poster: Social connection can mitigate disparities in depression symptoms
Society for Social Medicine & Population Health & European Congress of Epidemiology 2026: Flash talk: Social connection can mitigate disparities in depression symptoms
International Society for the Study of Behavioural Development 2026: Organised symposia: Social connection in society: Insights on mental health from four global cohorts, and presented a paper on Social connection can reduce disparities in depression symptoms
World Congress of Psychiatric Genetics 2025: Poster: Can social connection, acceptance, and belonging reduce disparities in depression symptoms?
European Social Science Genetics Network 2025: Poster: Illuminating the complex interplay of risk factors for depression within a large-scale US longitudinal cohort
Behavior Genetics Annual Meeting 2025: Talk: Illuminating the complex interplay of risk factors for depression within a large-scale US longitudinal cohort
World Congress of Psychiatric Genetics 2024: Poster: Drawing parallels across complex trait genomics and social science: A framework to combine social and genetic risk factors for depression
Behavior Genetics Annual Meeting 2024: Talk: Drawing parallels across complex trait genomics and social science: A framework to combine social and genetic risk factors for depression
Life History Research Society Conference 2024: Organised symposia: Social relationships and mental health difficulties in young people, and presented a paper on the overlap between social isolation and mental health symptoms: Longitudinal independent pathway model in a nationally representative cohort
Sociogenomics workshop Helsinki 2023: Poster: The overlap between social isolation and mental health symptoms: Longitudinal independent pathway model in a nationally representative cohort
European Social Science Genetics Network 2023: Poster: The overlap between social isolation and mental health symptoms: Longitudinal independent pathway model in a nationally representative cohort
European Psychiatric Association Paris Congress 2023: Talk: Do children with ADHD symptoms become socially isolated? Longitudinal within-person associations in a nationally representative cohort
International Convention of Psychological Science 2023: Poster: Do children with ADHD symptoms become socially isolated? Longitudinal within-person associations in a nationally representative cohort
Life History Research Society Conference at Oxford University 2022: Poster: Trajectories of childhood social isolation in a nationally representative cohort
26th Biennial Meeting of the ISSBD 2022: Poster: Trajectories of childhood social isolation in a nationally representative cohort

Qualifications and Training

- Introduction to Directed Acyclic Graphs Workshop and Demystifying Selection Bias with Peter Tennant 2026
- Social Inequality: Class, Race, and Gender graduate course (SOC611) led by Jeremy Reynolds at Purdue
- Genomic data cleaning and analysis led by Linus Schwantes-An, Indiana University
- International Statistical Genetics Workshop, University of Colorado Boulder

- Mental Elf Social Media Training
- Wellcome Genome Campus: Longitudinal studies conference and training
- Twin Research and Human Genetics at VU University of Amsterdam
- Longitudinal Structural Equation Modelling with CenterStat
- Growth Modelling in Mplus with Chris Stride
- LISS-DTP Introduction to Qualitative Research Programme
- Venipuncture Training Certified: Annie Barr Health Group
- Samaritans Training: Conversations with Vulnerable People

Funding and Awards

- Key personnel on National Institute of Health (NIH US) grant 2026: MCAP Longitudinal Summer Institute
- ISSBD 2026 Early Career Award
- Travel grants: ESSGN 2023; EPA 2023; SGDP Centre PhD Student Travel Grant 2022 & 2023; Purdue University Postdoc Travel Award 2026
- Editors' Best Research Article in 2023 by JAACAP Open: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jaacop.2024.01.001
- London Interdisciplinary Social Science Doctoral Training Partnership (LISS DTP) Studentship ESRC 2020
- Maudsley 2016 Grant for Samutthana Practical and Theoretical Mental Health Training in Sri Lanka

Publications

First Author

Wedow, R.†, Thompson, K. N.†, Medland, S. E.†, Nivard, M. G.†, Neale, B. M.† (2026). The need to consider complexity in the future of behavioural genetics. *Nature Genetics.*

Thompson, K. N. et al., (2026). Illuminating the complex interplay of risk factors for depression symptoms within a large-scale US longitudinal cohort. *Social Psychiatry and Psychiatric Epidemiology* https://doi.org/10.1007/s00127-026-03098-0

Malerbi, K . F.†, Brubaker, A.†, Weindling, M.†, Thompson, K. N.†, et al., (2026). Developing and Teaching Curriculum to Reduce Genetic Essentialism in College Classrooms. *Behavior Genetics.* https://doi.org/10.1007/s10519-026-10251-7

Thompson, K. N. et al., (2025). The overlap between social isolation and mental health problems: a longitudinal behavioural genetic analysis in the E-Risk cohort. *European Child & Adolescent Psychiatry*. https://doi.org/10.1007/s00787-024-02573-w

Thompson, K. N. (2024). Current Complexities in Establishing Risk Factors for Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder in Longitudinal Research. *Biological Psychiatry*, *95*(9), 820-821. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.biopsych.2024.02.1009

Thompson, K. N. et al., (2023). Do children with attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder symptoms become socially isolated? Longitudinal within-person associations in a nationally representative cohort. *JAACAP open*, *1*(1), 12-23. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jaacop.2023.02.001

Thompson, K. N. et al., (2022). Trajectories of childhood social isolation in a nationally representative cohort: Associations with antecedents and early adulthood outcomes. *JCPP Advances,* 2(2), e12073. *https://doi.org/10.1002/jcv2.12073*.

Thompson, K. N. et al., (2021). Age and sex-related variability in the presentation of generalized anxiety and depression symptoms. *Depression and Anxiety*, 38, 1054–1065. https://doi.org/10.1002/da.23213

Senior Author

Geurgas, R., et al., (2025). What Machine Learning Teaches Us About Depression Prediction Across the Life Course: An Exploratory Comparison of Predictive Models. *Social Science & Medicine Population Health.* https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ssmph.2025.101886

In Press

Thompson, K. N. et al., (2026). Social connection can mitigate depression risk. *Lancet Child and Adolescent Health*. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/j5drc_v1

Bryan, B., Thompson, K. N. et al., (2026). Investigating the interplay of loneliness and social isolation across adolescence: Findings from a nationally representative longitudinal study. *Development and Psychopathology.*

Grimes, P. et al., (2026). Transancestry GWAS of adolescent-onset depression. *Nature Genetics.* https://doi.org/10.1101/2025.09.26.25335972

Arseneault, L. et al., (2027). Chapter contribution for the Research Handbook on Loneliness and Social Connection. *Edward Elgar Handbooks*.

Brendgen, M. et al., (2027). The Cambridge Handbook of Developmental Gene-Environment Interplay: A Lifespan Perspective. *Cambridge*.

Collaborations

Dunn, E. C. et al., (2026). *Journal of Mood and Anxiety Disorders.* https://doi.org/10.1016/j.xjmad.2026.100171

Wedow, R., et al., (2026). *Human Genetics and Genomics Advances.* https://doi.org/10.1016/j.xhgg.2025.100548

Skelton, M. et al., (2025). *Psychological Medicine.* https://doi.org/10.1017/S0033291725101037

Morneau-Vaillancourt, G. et al (2025). *Journal of Affective Disorders.* https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jad.2025.04.010

Thériault-Couture, F. et al., (2024). *Developmental Psychology.* https://doi.org/10.1037/dev0001788

Bryan, B. T. et al., (2024). *Social Science & Medicine*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socscimed.2024.116697

Bryan, B. T. et al., (2023). *Occupational Medicine*. https://doi.org/10.1093/occmed/kqad138

Bright, S. J. et al., (2023). *BMC Psychiatry*. https://doi.org/10.1186/s12888-023-04890-x

Rayner, C. et al., (2022). *BMC Psychiatry*. https://doi.org/10.1186/s12888-022-04275-6

Young, **K. S.** et al., (2022). *Psychological Medicine*. http://doi.org/10.1017/S0033291722002501
Davies, M. R. et al., (2021). *Journal of Anxiety Disorders*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.janxdis.2021.102491
Holt, H. et al., (2021). *Thorax.* https://doi.org/10.1136/thoraxjnl-2021-217487
Peel, A. J. et al., (2021). *Journal of Affective Disorders Reports.* https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jadr.2021.100201

Other media
Organiser for Stand Up for Science Indiana Rally (2025): Link 1; Link 2
ACAMH Panel speaker (2025): Link
IoPPN Media (2022, 2023). Place2Be's Children's Mental Health Week: Link1 Link2 Link3
Edit Lab Blog (2022). Link